class parental background, foreign trained teachers and alternative textbooks, as well as education in English. Government schools on the other hand often have badly trained teachers and are limited by narrow (sometimes outdated) government textbooks with students studying only in Urdu. The philanthropic alternative will differ depending on the type of organization that runs the school. All these factors influence how the students learn about the state and how they will view their position.

But it is also important to note that the issue of class and school choice is no longer as clear-cut as it used to be with the elite and the middle classes sending their children to private schools and others going to either government schools or madrassas.[8] This is partly due to the explosion of low-fee private schools catering to the lower middle classes and the poorer sections of society. As the middle classes have diversified in income and ability to pay, new schools catering to them emerged. In parallel, philanthropic schools have started to offer alternatives to poorer sections of society as well. The middle classes always had a choice – and that choice from very early on was to buy out of the state sector. In doing so the middle classes weakened the citizenship bond and ensured that the quality of public education plummeted. Today an interesting development shows middle-class families also opting for secondary madrassas, which beyond the national curriculum offer a very restrictive view of the state, focusing rather on Pakistan's religious identity. Choice now has come to poorer sections of society as well with International Non-Governmental Organization (INGO)-supported schools, low-fee (sometimes low-quality) private schools and philanthropic provision on offer. In following the lead of the middle classes the move made by the poor has further weakened the link between the state and society. Not much is known about what drives choice for the poor, barring the obvious (school close/walking distance from home, especially important for girls in rural areas; good reputation, teachers being present etc.). Middle-class school choice has always been driven by wanting to give children a head start and being 'different' from others (Ball 2003; Vincent and Ball 2007). What is interesting is the consequences of this choice both in terms of the differing attitudes and the severance of the bond with the state.

Young people's voices

Participants in this study were asked questions about their understanding of what it means to be a Pakistani, the meaning of citizenship in Pakistan, and the